front matter

foreword

The data mesh is to data as agile is to software engineering, or as microservices are to architecture patterns. It will be an essential component of your future data strategy. *Data Mesh in Action* addresses both the technology of the data mesh and the methodology your organization can follow to implement it.

This book teleports you into the seat of the chief architect on a data mesh project. The authors will coach you through the chaotic process of your first data product. As you gain more and more of those components, your mesh will build itself. The authors' collective experience drives this transformation. Your responsibility will be to pick, choose, and adapt this framework to your needs and organization.

The data mesh is based on four key principles: domain ownership, data as a product, federated computational governance, and self-serve data platform. The book details organizational impact of these principles, as well as their technology, in great length. Individually, all those principles are well-known to engineers and architects; the real (r)evolution of the data mesh is its ability to combine them and deliver a global approach to building modern data platforms.

In my more than 15 years of building hybrid data platforms, I have always been missing something. Whether it was due to the strict approach of ingesting data in a warehouse or the lack of governance of a lake, to name two popular patterns, there was always this feeling of "it ain't gonna work." The mesh is different. It does not focus solely on technology; it puts governance and quality at the center and allocates ownership to the real owner, not some central commanding and demanding group. As a result, with adequate self-service tools, the data mesh will liberate the forces of innovation in your organization. And that is what this book will help you achieve.